

HEC PARIS

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT HEC PARIS

HEC Paris is one of the leading MBA programs in Europe, offering a 16-month program of study with two intakes: January and September. It occupies a unique space between the one-year programs like INSEAD and traditional two-year programs. Its 16-month program offers the intensity of an accelerated program while allowing students to pursue an internship or fieldwork project for one of the four-month segments. Many students have taken advantage of this option to gain entry to their post-MBA employers in cities like London, Paris, New York, and Hong Kong. As part of the Paris Saclay Innovation Cluster, HEC Paris is able to attract some of the most innovative partners to work alongside students.

The program's reputation and international scope have grown in recent years - its regularly ranked amongst the top three European business schools by the Financial Times, and 90 percent of students hail from outside France. The institution has graduated more CEOs of Fortune Global 500 companies than any other university in Europe, according to the 2017 Times Higher Education Alma Mater Index. It has also formed significant double degree partnerships with schools like Yale and NYU in the United States, LSE in the UK, and Chinese University of Hong Kong and Tsinghua University in Beijing, creating diverse global opportunities to experience two international schools with their full alumni networks and career services.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Marketing, Strategy, Entrepreneurship

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*

	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
BusinessWeek	10	52	4	4	*	*	2
Financial Times	20	21	19	9	7	11	17
US News	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Poets and Quants	-	-	5	4	4	6	10

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants	NA	Avg Age	30
MBA Class Size	243	Avg GMAT	690
Annual Tuition	€92,000	% International	95%
Avg Work Experience	6	% Women	38%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Consulting	25%
Technology	23%
Financial Services	15%
Retail / Luxury	8%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Amazon, Bain & Company, BCG, Deloitte, Deutsche Telecom, DHL Consulting, EY, Infosys, Global Praxis, Google Hilti, Kearney, KPMG, McKinsey, Microsoft, Petronas, Roland Berger, Simon Kutcher & Partners, Uber, Wipro

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: **US\$115,827**

SALARY INCREASE: **124%**

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: **92%**



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR HEC PARIS APPLICATION

BY BRENDAN KRAMP

Brendan served as the UK Director of Development for INSEAD and earned an MBA from HEC with a semester spent at NYU Stern. In addition to his MBA, Brendan holds a Masters in writing.



Articulate your uniqueness strongly in your application, along with how a global vision for your future will both benefit from and contribute to the alumni network of HEC.

1

ARTICULATE AN INFORMED, GLOBAL VISION FOR YOUR FUTURE.

Focus on how HEC's international scope, deep academic rigor and program structure, and access to a worldwide network fits with your goals and aspirations. HEC looks for academic performance and solid GMAT scores (2020 average of 691), in addition to ambitious career aspirations and backgrounds. You'll also want to think about what differentiates you from your peers. Articulate your uniqueness strongly in your application, along with how a global vision for your future will both benefit from and contribute to the alumni network of HEC.

HOW DOES INTERNATIONAL FIT IN YOUR CAREER GOALS?

2

HEC has become a very international MBA program, and global experience is important and a real differentiator for candidates coming to the program. If you have lived or worked outside your own home country, think about what you learned inter-culturally and how that influenced you both as a person and as a professional. If you have not left your own country but have interacted with global teams, clients, service providers or vendors, think about one-to-two examples that are the most prominent and how you learned to work with people across different cultures, backgrounds and languages. How did you adapt your own style of working and outlook in order to achieve mutual success? This can be very powerful as part of your application. While experience traveling to other countries for vacation or short stints is valuable, be careful about listing a series of places you have visited like an itinerary. HEC is looking for what you learn from international exposure, how you changed, and how that relates to your career and life objectives. It is always most powerful to use a specific example such as someone you met or an experience you had that changed the way you relate to the world and yourself.

3

THE INTERVIEW PRESENTATION

HEC asks candidates who are invited to interview to make a short 10-minute presentation on a subject of their choice. This is an opportunity to showcase your composure and clarity of thought, ability to deliver a coherent argument or explanation, and to express both creativity and passion in your presentation. It does not have to relate to your job or career – in fact some of the best presentations don't – but it should be a subject that is relevant to you, and that you can communicate well to the interviewer. It's also important that you keep your presentation short – five or six slides should be plenty, including the introductory slide. What you want to do in 10 short minutes is impress a concept or new way of thinking to your interviewer and show how you have come to a specific conclusion or observation. Keep it engaging and interesting, too – the more memorable, the better.

KNOW HOW HEC IS UNIQUE.

4

HEC is different than many of its European counterparts because, like many US schools, the MBA program runs alongside a larger population of college-aged students studying business for a Masters in Management at the Grande Ecole. The HEC Grande Ecole is one of the top-rated programs in the continent, which is tremendous benefit to the MBA. For one, many professors teach in both the MBA and Grande Ecole, in addition to attracting to campus top speakers, recruiters and more. HEC has also distinguished itself by organizing the yearly MBA Tournament (MBAT), a months-long, class-wide project that involves volunteers, committees, gathering resources, teams and more. It's one of the features and bonding exercises that make the HEC MBA unique, and a real hands-on learning experience.

In terms of translating this to your essays and interviews, it's advantageous to tie your interests and plans to people or companies that demonstrate HEC's impact in the world. It can work well in your application to mention a few HEC alumni who have risen to leadership positions at the kinds of company or organizations that appeal to you. Do reach out to any local HEC alumni in your area working at different companies to glean firsthand insights on the program and what they thought about it - mentioning how you learned more about HEC directly from alumni gives you both perspective and an authentic edge when you write about some of the program aspects that appeal most.

5

CONNECT YOUR NARRATIVE AND CAREER VISION TO HEC'S VALUES.

While schools are looking for certain key competencies and achievements from candidates, it goes beyond your ability to get in and do well in the program. Every school wants candidates who will contribute to the school in the long run through your work, career progression, future leadership positions, involvement and more. You are selling your future vision as much as your current skills, GMAT scores, and accomplishments, so it's essential to know how your career goals intersect with the school's values and link them across your narrative about your reasons for pursuing the MBA. Think about how your life and career will look if everything goes the way you plan, and how that will also be of value to the school. Do you plan on starting your own company one day? Do you want to lead change in the way we source energy? Do you have a passion for using technology to solve a previously intractable problem? All of these are great stories about your future, and they become even better when you tie them to the specific characteristics of the school and how the program will help you get to that goal. This is also something that the school will enjoy highlighting when you get there, demonstrating the life-long value and impact that an MBA from HEC can make.

Read Fortuna's insider guidance for the HEC essays [here](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE		APPLICATION DEADLINE
JANUARY 2024 INTAKE	14 August		11 December
	11 September		15 January 2024
	13 October		12 February 2024
	13 November		18 March 2024
		SEPTEMBER 2024 INTAKE	



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

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